

Students are advised to retain course outlines for future use in support of applications for employment or transfer of credits.

Instructor

Croney, Aynslie

Room

A3011/ Online

Availability

Thursdays 10:30 am to 12:20 pm (online); or by appointment

Email

aynslie.crony@nbcc.ca

Program Title

GCD Graphic Design 2026 - 2028 (Fall Intake)

Campus(es) being delivered to:

NBCC Moncton Campus

Delivery Mode

Blended Delivery

Period of Delivery

Fall 2026 (From 2026-09-08 to 2026-12-18)

Classroom

A3020/MS Teams

Course Schedule

In-Class: Tuesday and Wednesday 10:30 am to 12:20 pm

Online: Thursday 10:30 am to 12:20 pm

Credits

6

Grading Basis

Graded

Pass mark

60%

Description

This course provides learners with foundational knowledge and skills in the design of visual solutions. Learners will explore the elements, principles, and multi-disciplinary examples of design to communicate visually, considering the intended message and audience.

Course Outcome

Communicate visually, applying the elements and principles of design.

Competencies

The following competencies will be achieved:

1. consider the intended message and audience when designing a visual solution
2. research historical references to inspire and enhance graphic design ideas
3. incorporate the elements of: line, shape, direction, size, texture, and/or colour effectively
4. interpret colour theory for design
5. apply colour theory to optimize visual design solutions
6. employ a variety of colour schemes to accurately reflect the mood/impact of the message
7. apply the principles of: balance, proximity, alignment, repetition, contrast, and/or space effectively
8. select appropriate type styles and sizes
9. critique existing graphic designs to assess strengths and weaknesses
10. outline appropriate selection and usage of stock images
11. describe copyright laws, legislation, regulations, and ethics as they relate to graphic design

Essential Skills

Participation in the learning activities related to this course will reinforce the development of essential skills such as the following:

1. Communicate
 - 1.1. Read, listen, and comprehend information presented in a variety of forms (e.g., words, graphs, charts, diagrams, voice, sound)
2. Manage Information
 - 2.1. Access, gather, organize and interpret information using appropriate information systems and technology with the accuracy required to complete tasks
3. Participate in Projects and Tasks
 - 3.1. Plan, design, or carry out a project or task from start to finish with well-identified outcomes

Activities / Assessments**Exercise (18 %)****Weight(%)****In-Class Exercises****18**

Through a series of in-class exercises, students will explore the elements, principles, and multi-disciplinary examples of design to communicate visually, considering the intended message and audience.

Each in-class exercise is worth 2% of final grade

An in-class assignment is assigned and completed before the end of class. They are used to help you adjust to the industry, in which you will be given a project and expected to complete it by a specific deadline. The student is responsible for informing the instructor BEFORE class begins and requesting to complete the assessment at another time if they cannot attend. A zero will be assigned to missed in-class assignments that have not been previously arranged to complete outside of class.

September 16 Line, Shape, & Direction
September 22 Size, Texture, & Colour
September 23 Hierarchy
September 29 Balance & Proximity
October 6 Alignment & Repetition
October 7 Contrast & Space
October 13 Ad Mock-up
November 18 Layout Dissection
November 24 Bad Layout Dissection

Competencies covered:

1. consider the intended message and audience when designing a visual solution
3. incorporate the elements of: line, shape, direction, size, texture, and/or colour effectively
4. interpret colour theory for design
7. apply the principles of: balance, proximity, alignment, repetition, contrast, and/or space effectively
9. critique existing graphic designs to assess strengths and weaknesses

Teamwork (10 %)**Weight(%)**

Through a series of discussion boards, students communicate with each other about a variety of design theory topics. They will build on previous learning and the current week's topics.

Each discussion board will be open for two hours to encourage timely participation. They will be treated as in-class assignments.

Each discussion board is worth 2% of the final grade

An in-class assignment is assigned and completed before the end of class. They are used to help you adjust to the industry, in which you will be given a project and expected to complete it by a specific deadline. The student is responsible for informing the instructor BEFORE class begins and requesting to complete the assessment at another time if they cannot attend. A zero will be assigned to missed in-class assignments that have not been previously arranged to complete outside of class.

September 17 Line, Shape, & Direction
 September 24 Size, Texture, Colour, & Hierarchy
 October 1 Balance & Proximity
 October 8 Alignment, Repetition, Contrast & Space
 November 26 Self Layout Dissection

Competencies covered:

1. consider the intended message and audience when designing a visual solution
3. incorporate the elements of: line, shape, direction, size, texture, and/or colour effectively
4. interpret colour theory for design
5. apply colour theory to optimize visual design solutions
6. employ a variety of colour schemes to accurately reflect the mood/impact of the message
7. apply the principles of: balance, proximity, alignment, repetition, contrast, and/or space effectively
8. select appropriate type styles and sizes
9. critique existing graphic designs to assess strengths and weaknesses

Assignment (42 %)

Weight(%)

Assignments

Assignments are completed outside of the classroom and lab. Students are responsible for submitting their projects by the due date and time. Late assignments incur a penalty of 10% per day for up to 5 days. Full details are found in the Graphic Design Handbook on page 6.

Before Critique Activity

2

Assigned Week 1
 Due: September 14 by 11:59 pm

Competencies covered:

1. consider the intended message and audience when designing a visual solution
2. research historical references to inspire and enhance graphic design ideas
9. critique existing graphic designs to assess strengths and weaknesses

Black and White Mock-Up

5

Assigned Week 6
 Due: October 21 by 10:30 am

Competencies covered:

3. incorporate the elements of: line, shape, direction, size, texture, and/or colour effectively
7. apply the principles of: balance, proximity, alignment, repetition, contrast, and/or space effectively
8. select appropriate type styles and sizes

Colour Wheel

10

Assigned Week 7
Due: November 4 by 10:30 am

Competencies covered:
4. interpret colour theory for design
5. apply colour theory to optimize visual design solutions

Colour Schemes

5

Assigned Week 8
Due: November 10 by 10:30 am

Competency covered:
6. employ a variety of colour schemes to accurately reflect the mood/impact of the message

After Critique Activity

10

Assigned Week 12
Due: December 7 by 11:59 pm

Competencies covered:
1. consider the intended message and audience when designing a visual solution
2. research historical references to inspire and enhance graphic design ideas
3. incorporate the elements of: line, shape, direction, size, texture, and/or colour effectively
4. interpret colour theory for design
7. apply the principles of: balance, proximity, alignment, repetition, contrast, and/or space effectively
9. critique existing graphic designs to assess strengths and weaknesses

Full Colour Mock-Up

10

Assigned Week 12
Due: December 15 by 10:30 am

Competencies covered:
1. consider the intended message and audience when designing a visual solution
2. research historical references to inspire and enhance graphic design ideas
3. incorporate the elements of: line, shape, direction, size, texture, and/or colour effectively
4. interpret colour theory for design
5. apply colour theory to optimize visual design solutions
6. employ a variety of colour schemes to accurately reflect the mood/impact of the message
7. apply the principles of: balance, proximity, alignment, repetition, contrast, and/or space effectively
8. select appropriate type styles and sizes
10. outline appropriate selection and usage of stock images

Quiz (10 %)

Weight(%)

Students need to be able to find and use appropriate stock photography; they must also adhere to copyright laws. This quiz will examine their knowledge of these two areas.

November 19 at 10:30 am online via MS Teams

A zero will be assigned to missed quizzes unless an extraordinary circumstance exists. The student is responsible for informing the instructor BEFORE class begins. If extraordinary circumstances exist, an instructor makes every reasonable effort to make alternative arrangements.

Competencies covered:

10. outline appropriate selection and usage of stock images
11. describe copyright laws, legislation, regulations, and ethics as they relate to graphic design

Examination (20 %)	Weight(%)
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Final Exam	20
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Understanding design theory is as important as applying the theory. This exam will cover all the course competencies.

December 15 at 10:30 am in class

A zero will be assigned to missed tests unless an extraordinary circumstance exists. The student is responsible for informing the instructor BEFORE class begins. If extraordinary circumstances exist, an instructor makes every reasonable effort to make alternative arrangements.

Competencies covered:

1. consider the intended message and audience when designing a visual solution
2. research historical references to inspire and enhance graphic design ideas
3. incorporate the elements of: line, shape, direction, size, texture, and/or colour effectively
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Other	Weight(%)
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Plagiarism and Academic Integrity	
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NBCC is committed to the highest standards of academic integrity and honesty. Students are urged to become familiar with and uphold Policy 1111 Academic Integrity.

Plagiarism detection tools such as Turnitin and Grammarly are integrated into Brightspace and may be used.

Remote proctoring using Respondus Monitor and LockDown Browser may also be used to ensure the academic integrity of assessments. Alternate testing arrangements may be arranged in advance (ie. live proctoring on campus).

Use of Generative AI

Academic integrity is a core principle at NBCC, and all students must uphold this principle, whether using AI-based tools or otherwise. For this class, responsible use of AI-based tools in completing coursework or assessments must be done per the following:

- You must clearly identify the use of AI-based tools in your work. Any work that utilized AI-based tools must be clearly marked as such, including the specific tool(s) used. For example, if you use ChatGPT, you must cite "ChatGPT. (YYYY, Month, DD of query). "Text of your query." Generated using Open AI. [website link]. See this article by APA on citing ChatGPT and other AI-generated works in your writing: <https://apastyle.apa.org/blog/how-to-cite-chatgpt>
- You must be transparent in how you used the AI-based tool, including what work is your original contribution. An AI detector such as Turnitin or GPTZero may be used to detect AI-driven work.
- You must ensure that using AI-based tools does not violate copyright or intellectual property laws.
- You must not use AI-based tools to cheat on assessments.
- You must not use AI-based tools to plagiarize without citation.

Required Resources

Laptop;
Access to Brightspace;
Adobe Creative Cloud;
Notebook/sketchbook;
Drawing pencils and/or pens;
Attendance and participation; and
An open mind and willingness to have fun.

NBCC is committed to the highest standards of academic integrity and honesty. Students are urged to become familiar with and uphold NBCC's policy concerning Academic Integrity. The plagiarism detection tool, Turnitin, is integrated into Brightspace and may be used.

Remote proctoring using Respondus Monitor and LockDown Browser, may also be used to ensure academic integrity of assessments. Alternate testing arrangements may be arranged in advance (i.e. live proctoring on campus).

Approved Electronically

Mary Lynn Jardine

Date

2026-09-09

NBCC promotes transparency in the application of its policies and procedures. Subsequently, numerous policies that apply to students can be viewed at <https://documents.nbcc.ca/>. Policies and procedures are regularly reviewed and updated. Please be sure to check the site regularly for the most up-to-date document.

Course Delivery and Evaluation of Learning NBCC is committed to ensuring quality delivery and evaluation methods in its courses and programs while providing supports and assisting students in achieving success, recognizing that there are circumstances when an unsuccessful grade may not reflect student learning. A Supplemental Evaluation Measure may be offered to students who receive an unsuccessful grade in a credit course, provided necessary criteria are met.

Grading and Academic Recognition NBCC uses a grading/credit system to indicate course grades which are translated to a transcript of marks that reflects the history of the student's academic progression and performance.

Academic Integrity NBCC is committed to promoting academic integrity throughout the college community. Academic honesty and integrity are fundamental expectations and requirements of students as they assume responsibility for their learning and actions.

Student Code of Conduct NBCC believes that learning in an adult education setting offers holistic development of the learner. A climate of collaboration and respect of self, of others and of established rules and regulations is the setting by which an effective environment of learning is established.

Accessibility Services NBCC will provide reasonable accommodation to students with disabilities in order to promote academic success. If you feel you may require accommodations or other forms of support while at NBCC, please talk to a Learning Strategist at your campus.

College Office of Research Enterprise (CORE) NBCC encourages incorporating research into course activities to enrich the learning experience. When research activities involve human participants, instructors should contact reb@nbcc.ca for guidance on when research ethics review is required, and how to apply.

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SIMS Class Number

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